# MIWAE Framework and Coursebook Fit Rubric

Printable handout for Pragmatic Considerations for Authors and Publishers on Modification of Input in Written Academic English

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github.com/MehmetDEU/MIWAE

**Purpose:** MIWAE supports transparent comparison of EMI textbooks for multilingual readers. It connects reader needs with observable textual choices and checks whether those choices appear where they are needed.

## How to read the framework

| Layer | Question answered | Required record |
|---|---|---|
| **Function** | What reader need does the feature address? | Select one of the seven dimensions and state the local purpose. |
| **Form** | Which observable textual, visual or numerical device supplies the function? | Record the feature and its page or segment location. |
| **Distribution** | How reliably is the form available across eligible points of need? | Define eligible opportunities before counting coverage, timing and spread. |
| **Reader evidence** | Do students notice, use or still need the support? | Keep student perceptions separate from textbook counts, then interpret them together. |

## Seven review dimensions

| Dimension | Review question | Observable forms | Distribution indicators |
|---|---|---|---|
| **1 Access to disciplinary meanings** | Are key terms unpacked where first needed? | Definition, gloss, adjacent paraphrase, worked example | First use coverage, proximity to the term, recurrence when meaning shifts |
| **2 Orientation and navigation** | Can readers see where the explanation is going? | Preview, roadmap, heading, recap, cross reference | Coverage at openings and transitions, chapter spread, consistency |
| **3 Rhetorical relations and importance** | Are claims, contrasts, causes and qualifications visible? | Relation marker, scope cue, importance cue | Coverage of eligible relations, placement, dispersion across modes |
| **4 Background knowledge** | Is required but potentially non shared context made accessible? | Context note, analogy, familiar label, local reference gloss | Coverage at assumed knowledge points, timing, purposeful repetition |
| **5 Conceptual continuity** | Are prerequisites reactivated where later explanations depend on them? | Recall cue, bridge, restatement, backward or forward reference | Coverage at conceptual dependencies, distance from prior content, recurrence |
| **6 Reader engagement and self monitoring** | Can readers check or monitor understanding at the learning point? | Question, self check, pause prompt, worked reasoning | Density per section, placement after learning point, feedback availability |
| **7 Multimodal support** | Do prose, visuals and notation explain one another? | Label, caption, figure reference, worked graph, aligned notation | Coverage of visual opportunities, co location with prose, cross chapter consistency |

## Coursebook fit rubric dimensions 1 to 4

Rate matched sample locations rather than impressions of the whole book. Set each dimension as essential, supporting or not applicable before inspection.

| Dimension and review question | 0 Unsupported | 1 Limited | 2 Adequate | 3 Systematic |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1 Meaning access**<br>**Are key terms unpacked where first needed?** | No explanation or a misleading explanation | A gloss appears late, rarely or without context | An accurate local explanation appears at main points of need | Terms, examples and references remain consistently aligned |
| **2 Orientation**<br>**Can readers see where the explanation is going?** | Structure and purpose remain opaque | Headings exist, but transitions remain weak | Useful previews, recaps and cross references guide main sections | Orientation recurs at major conceptual transitions |
| **3 Rhetorical relations**<br>**Are claims, contrasts and qualifications visible?** | Relations are obscured or incorrectly signalled | Some markers appear, with important gaps | Main relations and conditions are explicit | Relations remain explicit across prose, examples and visuals |
| **4 Background knowledge**<br>**Is required context made accessible?** | Essential context is silently assumed | Context appears after readers need it | Concise context or analogy appears at need | Context is calibrated and revisited without overload |

### Recording distribution

Coverage uses a defined denominator: supported opportunities divided by eligible opportunities in the matched sample. Also record timing and spread. For example, note whether support appears at first mention, arrives later, and occurs across several chapters rather than in one isolated passage.

**Perceived distribution** reports how many participants mention a need or support. Keep this measure separate from the textbook count.

## Coursebook fit rubric dimensions 5 to 7

| Dimension and review question | 0 Unsupported | 1 Limited | 2 Adequate | 3 Systematic |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **5 Conceptual continuity**<br>**Are prerequisites reactivated at dependence?** | Earlier concepts are silently assumed | Connections are distant or inconsistent | Bridges and recall cues appear at key dependencies | Connections build a visible cumulative knowledge path |
| **6 Reader engagement**<br>**Can readers check or monitor understanding?** | No usable route for checking understanding | Prompts are generic or detached | Questions and checks match the learning point | Checks recur with feedback or worked reasoning |
| **7 Multimodal support**<br>**Do prose, visuals and notation explain one another?** | Modes conflict or essential labels are missing | Visuals exist, but links remain weak | Labels and references support interpretation | Modes are deliberately sequenced and mutually explanatory |

## Mandatory gates

| Gate | Question |
|---|---|
| **Disciplinary accuracy** | Does the explanation preserve accurate disciplinary meaning? |
| **Precision preserved** | Does support clarify the material without removing necessary technical distinctions? |
| **No native speaker deficit assumption** | Does the judgement focus on communicative access and course fit rather than imitation of a native norm? |
| **Disciplinary fit** | Does the book support the course's epistemic and multimodal practices? |

### Evidence tags and decision rule

| Tag | Evidence basis | Decision | Rule |
|---|---|---|---|
| T | Text only: feature, page and denominator | Choose | Every essential dimension scores at least 2 and every gate passes. |
| TP | Text plus student perception | Choose and supplement | One essential dimension scores 1 and an explicit supplement can cover the gap. |
| TPC | Text, perception and comprehension evidence | Reconsider | An essential dimension scores 0, placement repeatedly fails, or an accuracy gate fails. |

Conceptual basis: Council of Europe (2020); Bjorkman (2013); Seidlhofer (2011); Mauranen, Hynninen and Ranta (2016); Jenkins and Mauranen (2019); McKinley (2025). MIWAE operationalises these orientations for coursebook review.

## Six step review procedure

| Step | Action | Record |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Profile the course and readers | English level, year, prior knowledge and reading tasks |
| 2 | Set priorities before inspecting books | Mark every dimension as essential, supporting or not applicable |
| 3 | Sample the same locations in every candidate | Include openings, term introductions, transitions, complex examples and chapter closes |
| 4 | Code function, form and distribution | Record the device, eligible opportunity, timing and chapter spread |
| 5 | Rate support and tag the evidence | Apply the 0 to 3 rubric and add T, TP or TPC |
| 6 | Choose, supplement or reconsider | Apply the decision rule and state any required teaching support |

## Coursebook evaluation sheet

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Coursebook and edition | | Course and discipline | |
| Intended readers | | Sample locations | |

| Dimension | Priority<br>E S N A | Rating<br>0 to 3 | Tag<br>T TP TPC | Page or sample evidence | Supplement or decision note |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 Meaning access | | | | | |
| 2 Orientation | | | | | |
| 3 Rhetorical relations | | | | | |
| 4 Background knowledge | | | | | |
| 5 Conceptual continuity | | | | | |
| 6 Reader engagement | | | | | |
| 7 Multimodal support | | | | | |

**Final decision:** Choose / Choose and supplement / Reconsider

Reason and required action: _____